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FEATURED

Stanford switches from Flock to Genetec after student backlash

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Stanford University has switched from Flock Safety to Genetec for its automated license plate readers following backlash from students, according to the university's official newsletter this week.

Aceptar

Negar lo no esencial

There were 19 Flock cameras on campus. Flock service officially ended in late July, and the cameras have since been turned off and physically covered, according to university spokesperson Luisa Rapport. They will be replaced with Genetec equipment by early September.

Flock cameras take photos of license plates and can share data with other law enforcement agencies, but opponents worry that they can be used for surveillance. Some are also worried about potential violations of state law that limits the sharing of license plate data.

Stanford's decision comes amid a wave of pushback against Flock from students. In May, students circulated a petition to remove the cameras. To date, the petition has collected over 1,000 signatures from Stanford staff, students, alumni and affiliates.

According to the university, Genetec's system differs from Flock's since it does not store captured images in the cloud for more than an hour. It would also not share data with third parties.



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